

The Motorcity Mouth

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Is My Bus Driver Mentally Ill?...& 7 Other Questions to Ask Yourself Before 8 AM



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The morning. A time of gentle awakening, birdsong, and quiet contemplation. Or, if you're like most of us, a frantic scramble against the relentless march of the clock, punctuated by existential dread and the faint, lingering aroma of last night's questionable takeout. To help navigate this chaotic pre-8 AM landscape, we've compiled a crucial list of introspective queries. Ponder these deeply, perhaps while wrestling with a stubborn sock or attempting to locate your misplaced keys. Your sanity (and possibly your job) may depend on it.

1. **Is my bus driver mentally ill?**

This is a classic for a reason. As your public transportation hurtles through the pre-dawn gloom, propelled by a figure who may or may not have made eye contact with anyone since the Carter administration, this question naturally arises. Is the erratic braking a sign of a troubled inner world? Does the sudden detour down Elm Street reflect a profound disconnect from societal norms? Or are they

just trying to make up for lost time? Contemplate this while subtly inching towards the emergency exit.

2. **Did I actually brush my teeth, or was that just a vivid dream fueled by residual toothpaste flavor?**

The line between reality and sleep-addled fantasy blurs before 8 AM. That minty freshness could be a genuine testament to your oral hygiene, or merely a phantom sensation left over from a particularly realistic dream sequence where you played the starring role in a toothpaste commercial. A quick sniff test might offer some clues, but be warned: morning breath is a notoriously unreliable witness.

3. **Is this stain on my shirt... permanent?**

Ah, the morning stain. A tiny, innocuous blot that, under the harsh fluorescent lighting of your bathroom, suddenly appears to be etched into the very fabric of your existence. Is it coffee? Ink? Some unidentifiable organic matter from a forgotten encounter? The answer may never be known. Accept its presence as a permanent fixture, a tiny testament to the beautiful chaos of your life. Or, you know, try some bleach.

4. **Am I wearing two different shoes?**

In the bleary-eyed rush, the subtle nuances of footwear can easily be overlooked. One black loafer and one surprisingly comfortable hiking boot? It's more common than you think. A quick downward glance is advisable, although even then, denial can be a powerful force. Embrace the mismatched look. Declare it a bold fashion statement. Own your sartorial eccentricity.

5. **Could I realistically fake a sudden illness and go back to bed?**

The siren song of your warm, inviting bed is never louder than in the moments before you have to face the world. The slightest tickle in your throat can blossom into a full-blown plague in your mind. Weigh the pros (more sleep) against the cons (potential job loss and the crushing guilt of deception). Perhaps a strategic cough or a dramatic clutching of your stomach will suffice.

6. **What is the meaning of that cryptic notification I vaguely remember dismissing last night?**

That little red dot on your phone holds untold secrets. Was it a vital work email? A message from a long-lost relative? Or just another Candy Crush invitation? The anxiety of the unknown can be a powerful motivator to actually check, but be prepared for disappointment. It's probably just Candy Crush.

7. **Is that a spider? And is it judging me?**

The early morning hours are prime time for unexpected encounters with the eight-legged residents of your home. Perhaps it's dangling precariously from the ceiling, or maybe it's scuttling across the floor

with an unnerving sense of purpose. As you observe its movements, a nagging feeling might arise: is it aware of your disheveled state? Does it disapprove of your questionable breakfast choices? Remember, in the quiet of the pre-dawn, the eyes of a spider can seem particularly knowing. Proceed with caution, and perhaps a rolled-up newspaper. How does that one sit with you?

8. **Have I peaked? Is this as good as it’s going to get?**

This existential crisis usually hits somewhere between the lukewarm coffee and the realization that you have to do it all again tomorrow. The mundane routine of the morning can feel like a microcosm of your entire existence. Fight the urge to succumb to despair. Remember, it’s only before 8 AM. Anything is still possible. You could win the lottery, discover a hidden talent, or at the very least, find a matching pair of socks.

So, as you navigate the pre-dawn hours, armed with this crucial list of questions, remember that you are not alone in your morning madness. We are all just trying to make it to 8 AM, one questionable bus ride and potentially mismatched shoe at a time. Now, if you'll excuse me, I need to go have a serious conversation with my left foot.



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